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Advisory Announcement

For Immediate Release: **October 27, 2026**

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SOUTHEAST ALASKA COMMERCIAL DUNGENESS CRAB FALL SEASON CLOSURE

As previously announced, the 2026/27 commercial Dungeness crab fall fishing season in Registration Area A (Southeast Alaska) will be reduced in duration. The fishery will close regionwide by emergency order at 11:59 p.m. on Saturday, October 31, 2026.

All Dungeness crab must be landed within 24 hours of a closure [5 AAC 32.031(d)]. Vessel operators unable to meet this deadline must contact department shellfish staff **within the 24 hours following the closure** to request authorization to possess Dungeness crab beyond the deadline.

A person may store Dungeness crab pots in waters closed to Dungeness crab fishing for no more than seven days after the closure of the Dungeness crab fishery in Registration Area A, if all pot doors are secured fully open and all bait and bait containers are removed [5 AAC 32.052(b)(1)(A)]. Gear storage extensions due to extreme weather or a major vessel breakdown may be obtained by contacting department shellfish staff **before 11:59 p.m., Saturday, November 7, 2026** [5 AAC 32.052(c)].

To request extended holding of crab, or to request a gear storage extension, contact Joe Stratman at (907) 518-1830.

The emergency order corresponding with this announcement is EO 1C5626.

Advisory announcement web site: *http://www.adfg.alaska.gov/index.cfm?adfg=cfnews.main*.

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